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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular Examination March 2026

Fourth Semester

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) – MG4DSEHIS201 – HISTORY OF PUBLISHING IN KERALA

(2024 Admission onwards)

Scheme of Valuation

Part A

MCQ

Answer any 10 questions. Each carries **1** mark

1. b). 1846
2. a). Preservation and dissemination of religious literature
3. a). Itty Achuthan
4. b). Paulinose Padire
5. b). Malayalam Journalism
6. c) 19th century
7. b). Church Mission Society
8. b). Swadeshabhimani
9. a). Vikramaditya
10. b). Malayalam journalism
11. b). Education and literacy
12. b). To produce academic books and technical glossaries in Malayalam. (1x10=10)

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any **5 questions.** Each question carries **2** marks

13. Missionary scholars played a crucial role in the development and growth of Malayalam prose, especially during the 19th century. Missionaries established schools and promoted mass education. They started early Malayalam journals and magazines. They established some of the earliest printing presses in Kerala, which made it possible to produce books, pamphlets, and periodicals in Malayalam. This helped standardize written prose and increased its reach.
14. LMS missionaries founded many schools where English was taught along with Malayalam. These institutions provided access to modern education, especially in regions like South Kerala. They introduced subjects such as science, mathematics, and history, all taught through English.
15. Varthamana Pusthakam is the first known travelogue written in Malayalam, authored by Paremmakkal Thoma Kathanar in 1790.
16. S T Reddiar who started as a street book seller established Vidyabhivardhini or VV press at Quilon in 1886.

17. Paschimodayam was a 19th-century Malayalam-language periodical published by the Basel Mission. Launched in 1847, it is recognized as one of the earliest Malayalam magazines, marking a formative stage in the region's print culture and intellectual exchange.
18. Kandathil Varghese Mappilai was the founder-editor of Malayala Manorama and started publication from Kottayam in 1890 as weekly.
19. Mathrubhumi is a Malayalam newspaper that is published from Kerala It was founded by K. P Kesava Menon.
20. SPCS established in 1945 at Kottayam with 12 writers. Its main objectives are a cooperative society for helping the writers to publish their works as well as getting them a decent remuneration. (2x5=10)

Part C
Short Essay Questions

(Answer any 4**.** Each carries **5** marks)

21. The Basel Mission Press at Thalassery, under the leadership of Hermann Gundert, played a vital role in the development of Malayalam language, literature, and journalism. Under Gundert's guidance, the press became one of the most important centres for printing in Kerala. It produced books, textbooks, and periodicals in Malayalam, making printed materials widely available.
22. There are three stages. First stage was missionaries age and second stage was the freedom movement age i.e., from 1886 to 1945. Third stage starts from 1945 onwards.
23. Devji Bhimji started a printing press at Cochin in 1865 under the name the Keralamitram Press. He launched a newspaper Keralamitram on 1881.
24. Nationalist newspapers played a crucial role in Kerala's political awakening during the late 19th and early 20th centuries. They acted as powerful tools for spreading political ideas, mobilizing public opinion, and resisting colonial rule. Newspapers such as Swadeshabhimani and Kesari promoted the ideals of freedom, self-rule (Swaraj), and national unity. They helped people understand the goals of the Indian national movement.
25. Mangalam played a significant role in the growth of commercial journalism in Kerala, especially from the late 20th century onward. *Mangalam* shifted focus from purely political or literary journalism to people-centric and entertainment-oriented content. It included cinema news, human-interest stories, crime reports, and features that appealed to a wider audience.
26. The Kerala Sahitya Akademi has played a central role in shaping Malayalam literature through its wide-ranging and systematic publication activities. The Kerala Sahitya Akademi has played a central role in shaping Malayalam literature through its wide-ranging and systematic publication activities.
27. In 1966, N. E Balakrishna Marar started Poorna Publications at Calicut which soon became a big publishing concern. It published old and new generation author's books. Books published by Poorna publications were distributed through Touring Book Stall. He started a Touring Book Stall (TBS) in Calicut 1951. (5x4=20)

Part D
Essay Questions
Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 15 marks

28. Rev. Benjamin Bailey played a foundational role in establishing modern printing in Kerala, particularly through his pioneering efforts in Kottayam during the early 19th century. Benjamin Bailey established one of the earliest printing presses in Kerala in 1821 at CMS Press under the auspices of the Church Missionary Society. Bailey was instrumental in designing and casting the first Malayalam movable types. Bailey's press laid the foundation for later developments in Malayalam journalism and publishing.
29. The early periodicals published in and around Kochi played a crucial role in shaping literacy and education during the 19th and early 20th centuries. By promoting reading habits, simplifying language, supporting formal education, and spreading modern knowledge, they significantly enhanced literacy and laid the foundation for Kerala's later achievements in education.
30. Kesari Balakrishna Pillai occupies a pivotal place in the evolution of modern literary criticism in Kerala. His contributions mark a decisive shift from traditional, moralistic evaluation of literature to a more analytical, modern, and globally informed critical approach.
31. Current Books has played a significant role in the growth and modernization of the publishing industry in Kerala. Established in the mid-20th century, it became one of the leading publishing houses that shaped reading culture and book distribution in the state. By expanding book production, strengthening distribution, supporting authors, and promoting reading culture, it played a vital role in the evolution of the publishing industry in the state.

(15x2=30)